

Arctic tern

These birds have the longest migration of any animal in the world. Every year, they fly about 50,000 miles (80,000 km) from the Arctic to Antarctica and back.



Northern Lights Cathedral

This spiral-topped cathedral in the town of Alta, Norway, takes its name from the lights in the sky that can be seen in the far north.



Polar bears

Polar bears, the largest creatures in the Arctic, spend most of their lives on sea ice. Melting ice, due to a rise in global temperatures, is shrinking their habitat.



- 5,600,000 sq miles (14,500,000 sq km)
- 4 million
- None
- Indigenous languages (+40), other languages (+7)

The **northernmost regions** of **North America**, **Russia**, and **Europe** lie within the **Arctic Circle**. Cold, treeless **tundra** cover the land, while the icy **Arctic Ocean** has the **North Pole** in its center.

The Arctic

Yu'pik people

The Arctic is home to many indigenous peoples, such as the Yu'pik of Siberia and Alaska, who travel on snowshoes and use animal furs for clothing.



The **Arctic Ocean** is the world's smallest ocean, surrounded by snowy landmasses.



Water-resistant fur keeps the bear warm in the freezing Arctic.

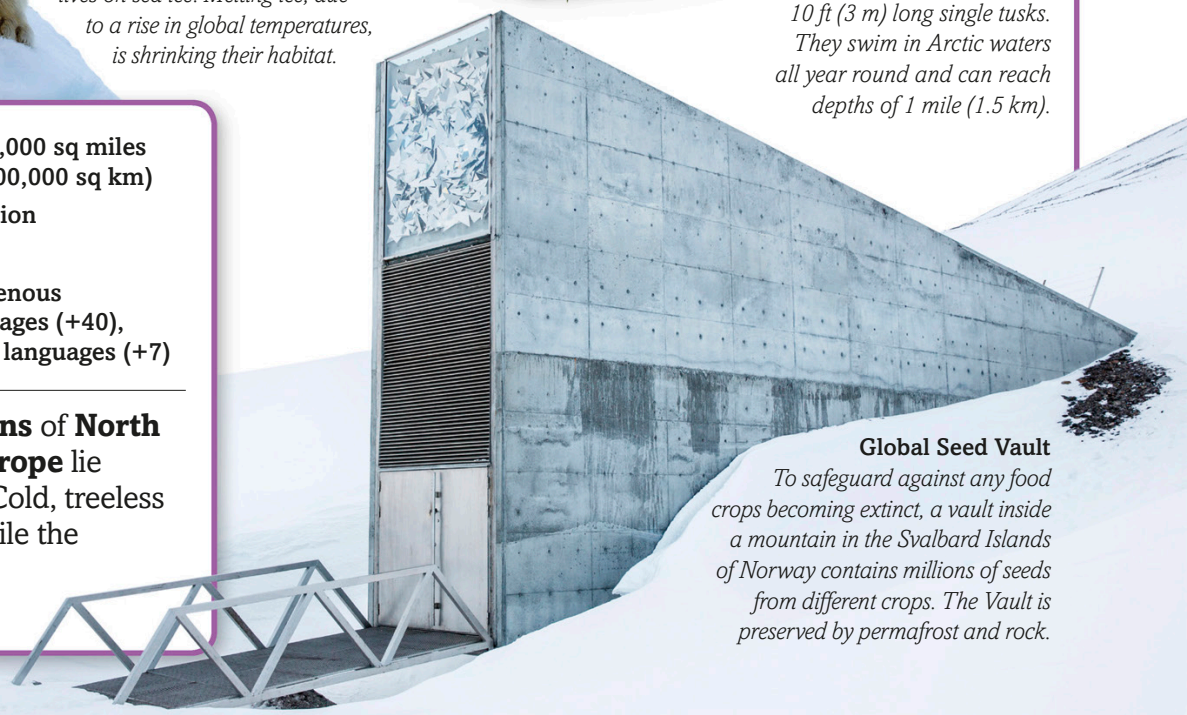
Hardy plants

Lichen, moss, and other tough plants, such as these Arctic poppies, thrive in the light, short Arctic summer when the sun does not set.



Arctic whales

A type of whale, narwhals are recognized by their up to 10 ft (3 m) long single tusks. They swim in Arctic waters all year round and can reach depths of 1 mile (1.5 km).



Global Seed Vault

To safeguard against any food crops becoming extinct, a vault inside a mountain in the Svalbard Islands of Norway contains millions of seeds from different crops. The Vault is preserved by permafrost and rock.